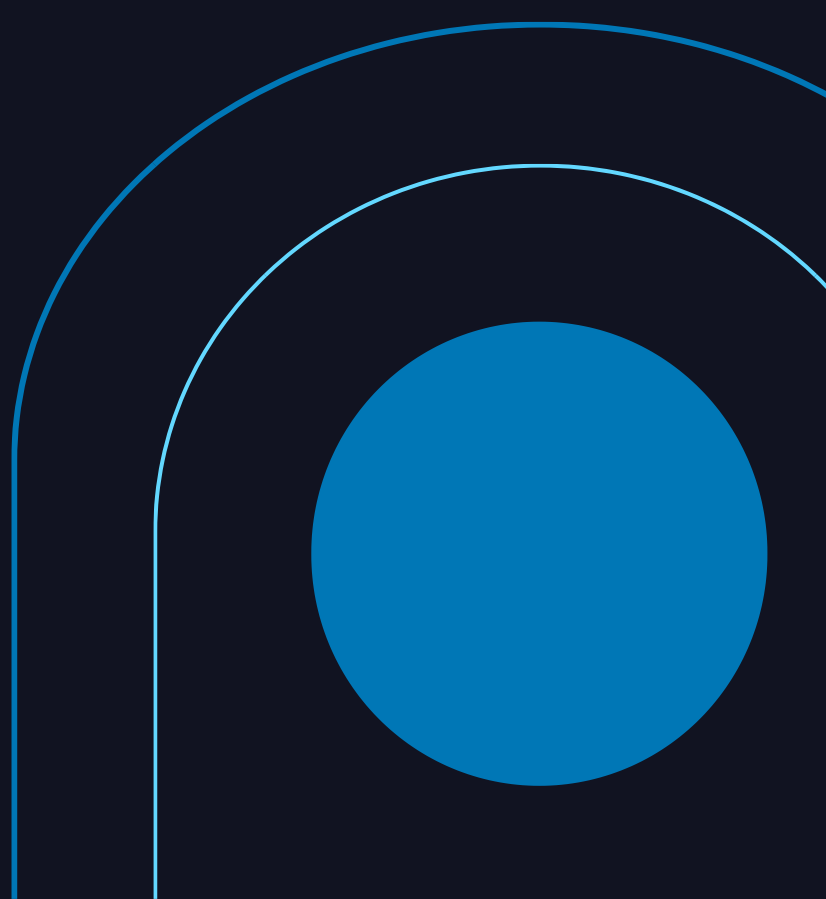


HACKATHON EDITION · 5-MINUTE PITCH

WINNING PRESENTATION STRATEGY

A practical guide for clear stories, effective slides,
convincing demos, and confident delivery.



Make one idea impossible to miss.

Judges need to understand the problem, trust the solution, and remember one decisive idea. Every slide, sentence, and demo step serves that journey.

01

Clarity beats volume.

A short, coherent story creates more confidence than a long feature list.

02

Proof beats promise.

A visible result, real signal, or concrete test makes the idea credible.

03

Momentum beats detail.

Each section answers one question and pulls the audience toward the next.

YOUR NORTH-STAR SENTENCE

[Audience] needs **[outcome]** because **[insight]**. WAYVE makes this possible through **[solution]**, which creates **[impact]**.

Use it as a filter: if a slide does not support this sentence, remove it or move it into backup.

The seven-slide story **fits five minutes.**

1	Hook	Open with tension or opportunity. State one memorable fact.	0:20
2	Human problem	Show who feels pain, what blocks them, and why this matters now.	0:35
3	Key insight	Reveal the observation that changes how judges see the problem.	0:30
4	Solution	Explain the idea in one sentence and show the core flow.	0:45
5	Live demo	Complete one realistic task from context to visible result.	1:30
6	Value + feasibility	Quantify impact and name the next technical or business step.	0:45
7	Close + ask	Return to the hook, repeat the value, and make one clear ask.	0:35
ONE SLIDE PERFORMS ONE JOB.			TOTAL · 5:00

Every slide earns its place.

01 Lead with the conclusion.

The headline states what a judge should understand, not just the topic.

02 Use one core idea.

One message per slide keeps attention on the story.

03 Make text readable.

Use large type, short lines, and only the words that support your voice.

04 Prefer evidence.

Show a product screen, number, quote, diagram, or direct comparison.

05 Show relationships.

Use position, scale, and sequence to explain how ideas connect.

06 Create strong contrast.

Make the key point visually dominant and keep support quiet.

07 Keep one visual system.

Repeat type, spacing, color, and alignment so the deck feels intentional.

08 Remove decoration.

If an element adds no meaning, it competes with the message.

The three-second test

Show the slide for three seconds. A teammate should name the main point without explanation. If they cannot, simplify the slide.

Show one complete **moment of value.**

A demo is not a product tour. It is evidence that the central promise works for a real person in a real situation.

CONTEXT	Set the scene. Name the user, their goal, and the constraint in one sentence.
ACTION	Follow the shortest path. Show only the interactions that reveal the key mechanism.
RESULT	Pause on the outcome. Give the room time to see what changes and why it matters.
PROOF	Connect back to impact. Use one signal or metric to show the value of the result.

Protect the live path.

Use stable data, close distractions, silence notifications, and keep the demo state ready before the pitch begins.

Prepare a backup.

Keep a 45-second screen recording and static proof slides available offline. The story continues even when the network does not.

Say what changes for the user, not where you click.

Confident delivery feels **simple and coordinated.**

OPENER

Creates attention.

Frames the problem and gives the audience a reason to care now.

GUIDE

Builds the logic.

Connects the insight, solution, and value in plain language.

BUILDER

Makes it real.

Runs the demo, explains the mechanism, and handles technical depth.

A CLEAN HANDOFF

“That is the opportunity. Alex now shows how WAYVE turns it into a working experience.”

FACE

Turn toward the audience, not the screen.

PACE

Speak slower than normal conversation.

PAUSE

Leave space after the strongest idea.

LOOK

Share eye contact across the room.

FINISH

End each sentence before the next speaker starts.

Energy comes from conviction, not speed.

Practice makes the pitch predictable.

ROUND 01

Story

Present without a timer. Fix confusing logic and remove anything that does not serve the central idea.

ROUND 02

Time

Run the full pitch with transitions. Cut until the team finishes with a ten-second buffer.

ROUND 03

Pressure

Invite interruptions, switch the display, and test the backup demo. Keep the story intact.

Five-part scorecard

0 = unclear · 1 = partial · 2 = strong

Problem clarity

0 · 1 · 2

Memorable insight

0 · 1 · 2

Visible proof

0 · 1 · 2

Credible impact

0 · 1 · 2

Confident close

0 · 1 · 2

Total — simplify below 8

/ 10

Answer first.

Give the direct answer before context. Judges can then follow the reasoning without searching for your position.

Bridge to proof.

Connect each response to the demo, research, architecture, or metric that supports it.

Finish with focus, **not more features.**

60–45 MIN

Freeze the story.

Confirm the north-star sentence, slide order, roles, and time budget.

45–30 MIN

Polish core slides.

Strengthen headlines, enlarge proof, and remove anything nonessential.

30–20 MIN

Verify the demo.

Reset data, test offline assets, and place the backup within one click.

20–10 MIN

Run the full pitch.

Practice transitions and finish with a ten-second buffer.

10–0 MIN

Protect your energy.

Stop editing. Breathe, drink water, and enter the room together.

☐ The deck opens offline.

☐ Every headline states a point.

☐ The demo starts from a clean state.

☐ The backup video plays locally.

☐ Each speaker knows the handoff.

☐ The final ask is specific.

CLOSING SCRIPT

“[Audience] faces [problem]. WAYVE turns [insight] into [solution], so [impact]. Today we show [proof]. With [ask], we create [next outcome].”

Winning is a by-product. Clarity, confidence, and proof are the strategy.